

Tata Power, Visa Power, CESC Ltd., Essar Power and others. Abhijeet Group has started their power project work in backward Latehar District.

The remote villages of the state are being provided with power through the non-conventional sources of energy. Solar lanterns, solar domestic lights, solar streetlights and solar water heating systems are being provided by the JREDA.

■ TOURISM: NATURE'S BOUNTY

Jharkhand is one of the most beautiful states of India, with a variety of forest reserves, water bodies, serene hills, and a variety of ethnic life. A total of 2.38 million hectares of the state



is forested. Cascading waterfalls like Hundroo and Jonha, and places of religious importance like Deoghar, Rajrappa, Parasnath and Madhuvan are a major tourist draw in the state, as are hill stations like Netarhat. The state government is inviting private participation in developing its beautiful tourist spots. The tourist spots, after being developed with proper infrastructure, would become a major source of revenue for the state. The government is planning to promote the state tourism sectorially, like Eco-tourism, Adventure tourism, Spiritual tourism, Mining tourism and culture tourism.

The state has many places of religious importance like the Parasnath temple in Giridih, which is a very popular pilgrimage centre for the Jains. One of the most revered pilgrimage centres in the country lies in this state -- the Baidyanath Dham at Deoghar.

The state has a rich heritage in tribal culture. They have their indigenous music, art forms, and way of life, for the protection and the fostering of which the government is providing opportunities. It is planning to provide a forum, where all the tribal cultures would converge, and could be therefore made available to interested tourists. The tourists could then get a unique chance to experience the ethnic lifestyles of the state and experience its folk traditions. In order to promote folk art and culture, the tourism department is organizing various fairs and celebrations in different districts across the state. These include the Chhau Festival (Saraikela Dist), Hizla Fair (Dumka Dist) and Tribal Festival (Netarhat). Adventure tourism also has immense scope in the state. Various Adventure tourism fests have been held in this respect at Jamshedpur, Ranchi,

Hazaribagh, Giridih, Gumla and Ghatshila.

Betla National Park is considered among the best national parks in India, providing a unique chance to observe wildlife from close quarters. The park provides a natural habitat to several species of animals such as the elephant, tiger, leopard, wild boar, gaur, sloth bear, sambar, chital, muntjac, nilgai, langur, mouse deer, rhesus monkey, small Indian civet, mongoose, porcupine, ant-eating pangolin, jackal, hyena and more. Huge herds of gaur, the Indian bison and elephants can be seen here almost throughout the year.

Netarhat, popularly called the 'Queen of Chhotanagpur', is 156 km west of Ranchi. It is a plateau covered with thick forests situated at a height of 3,700 feet or 1128 metres above sea level. Netarhat is a beautiful resort during summer. Dense forests, rolling hills, serpentine roads, cool bracing breeze, moonlit nights make a visit to Netarhat an unforgettable experience. The views of sunrise and sunset are fascinating. There are a number of places where one can stay, from the Hotel Prabhat Vihar of BSTDC and Palamu Bungalow, to many small places, which are ideal venues for viewing the breathtaking sunrise. At a distance of 10 km is the "Mangolia Point", famous for its stunning vista.

The beautiful dams within the state at Tilaiya, Maithon and Messenjore are being developed in order to popularize these spots. The government is also working on proper facelift, facility upgradation and beautification of waterfalls all around the state.

■ INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY : THE WORLD AT YOUR FINGERTIPS

An integrated I.T. policy was promulgated in December 2004 to ensure statewide e-governance. Since then, an information and communication network across the state, the Jharnet, has been implemented for efficiency and transparency. Computerisation of Treasuries, Commercial Tax Department, Registration processes, Municipal Services, Employment Exchange, Public Distribution Services, Sarva Siksha Aabhiyan and others will ensure efficiency. A Data & Network Centre, established in October, 2007 will greatly help in the development of the state through information technology. With these programmes, Jharkhand is poised to become one of the leading states of India in the 21st century.

Come, share our vision.

